University of Reading

Department of Computer Science

CS3IP: Individual Project

Assessment Criteria (Marking Scheme) and Mark Classification

This document offers the details of the assessment criteria (marking scheme) and mark classification. The first section describes the marking schemes, which will be used for the final year projects marking. The marking scheme section has a marking scheme for each of the following: project report, final presentation and demonstration, and project management. The criteria in each scheme have its associated marking weights and marking levels of the expected qualities. For example, the project report marking scheme has 9 criteria, and each criterion has different levels of qualities. The second section describes the mark classification, and it should be read to understand the overall quality of evidence associated with a classification in broad terms.

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Marking Scheme (Assessment Criteria)

Project report (60%)

Criteria for project report assessment	**Mark (100%)**
#1 Understanding of project context; definition of aims and objectives (background knowledge; problems/questions to be investigated; The commercial and economic context of the development)	**10**
Poor or inappropriate	0 – 4
Satisfactory	5 – 6
Good	7 – 8
Outstanding	9 - 10
#2 Social, legal, ethical issues and risk management (social consideration – impact of the project on individuals, communities, and society; legal compliance – regulatory adherence, intellectual property, liability and accountability, data governance; ethical framework – consent and privacy, code of conduct, transparency; risk management – risk assessment, mitigation plans)	**5**
Poor or inappropriate	0 – 1
Satisfactory	2 – 3
Outstanding	4 - 5
#3 Literature review (relevance of literature review of the state-of-the-art, and best practices in commercial computing solutions, with a critical analysis of findings and trade-offs in relation to addressing the research problem or question)	**15**
Poor or inappropriate	0 – 5
Satisfactory	6 – 9
Good	10 – 12
Outstanding	13 – 15
#4 Methodology (Data collection; algorithms/system design; Information security issues addressed or discussed; appropriate ethical approach incorporated)	**15**
Poor or inappropriate	0 – 5
Satisfactory	6 – 9
Good	10 - 12
Outstanding	13 - 15
#5 Experimentations/Implementations of programs/systems	**15**
Poor or inappropriate	0 – 5
Satisfactory	6 – 9

Good	10 - 12
Outstanding	13 - 15
#6 Results	**15**
Poor or inappropriate	0 – 5
Satisfactory	6 – 9
Good	10 - 12
Outstanding	13 - 15
#7 Discussion and analysis (validation of the outputs; justification/critique of achievements of the project)	**10**
Poor or inappropriate	0 – 4
Satisfactory	5 – 6
Good	7 – 8
Outstanding	9 - 10
#8 Originality of contributions (innovative solution approach adopted/adapted)	**5**
Poor or no evidence	0 – 2
Satisfactory	3 – 4
Outstanding	5
#9 Organization and presentation (logical structure, error-free writing; high quality references; use of citations for in-text tables and figures; quality of figures and captions; and within word limit of 20K words)	**5**
Poor or no evidence	0 – 2
Satisfactory	3 – 4
Outstanding	5
#10 Reflection (Reflection on the project/developments and the learning experience)	**5**
Poor or no evidence	0 – 2
Satisfactory	3 – 4
Outstanding	5

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Final presentation and demonstration (35%)

Presentation criteria		**Mark (100%)**
Presentation content quality		**30**
(introduction, problem definition and objectives, methodology, results, conclusions, content balance, content distribution and planning, citation of sources, self-reflection)	Poor	0 – 10
	Satisfactory	11 – 17
	Good	18 – 24
	Outstanding	25 – 30
Presentation style and delivery		**10**
(Presentation structure, content order, logical flow of messages, confidence in delivery, pace, engaging audiences, interactivity, use of visual aids, length and timing)	Poor	0 – 4
	Satisfactory	5 – 6
	Good	7 – 8
	Outstanding	9 – 10
Demonstration criteria		
Technical content		**20**
(clear scope and purpose of the application/program, logical navigation of application/program, innovative functions/features)	Poor	0 – 8
	Satisfactory	9 – 11
	Good	12 – 15
	Outstanding	16 – 20
Functionality and performance		**30**
(Correctness toward the intended purpose, reliable and executable functions/algorithms, appropriate user interface/visualisation of results, completeness)	Poor	0 – 14
	Satisfactory	15 – 20
	Good	21 – 24
	Outstanding	25 – 30
Demonstration quality		**10**
(Results correctness, clear and logical walk-through of codes/programs/applications, technical confidence, pace, timing)	Poor	0 – 4
	Satisfactory	5 – 6
	Good	7 – 8
	Outstanding	9 – 10

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Project management (5%)

Project management Evidence through logbook keeping, supervisory meetings, project management and blackboard submissions	**Mark (100%)**
Poor	0 – 39
Average	40 – 49
Acceptable	50 – 69
Satisfactory	70 – 79
Excellent	80 – 89
Outstanding	90 – 100

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Mark classification

When assessing a final year project, the assessor will be answering the following questions:

- Is the problem well-articulated and relevant?
- Is it demonstrating a clear and critical evaluation of background knowledge?
- Is the implementation complete?
- Is it presenting an appropriate analysis of results and conclusion?
- Is it original in some sense?
- Is the report clearly and comprehensibly written?

The first-class mark falls into the range between 70% to 100%.

90% – 100% (First class)

- *Background knowledge* – the project demonstrates: outstanding depth of knowledge, scientific awareness, and comprehensive understanding of the state-of-the-art theories, principles, and concepts; excellent competence in identifying new approach in problem formulation, modelling, framework or architecture, and methodology.
- *Experiment and implementation competence* – clear and complete experiments/implementations; highly appropriate use of methods and tools; clear, comprehensive, and correct results; and critical evaluation and analysis (or test and validation).
- *Originality and contributions* – projects in this classification show some originality and innovation in problem formulation, solution (algorithms/system design) approach, implementation (code), testing and validation (experimental analysis)
- *Presentation quality* – the project demonstrates: clear and lucid report writing, uniform reference and bibliography; high quality of tables and figures and their reference in text; excellent and well-directed presentation; logically structured report; largely correct grammar and spelling.
- The project may contain publishable material in a suitable journal or conference.

80% – 89% (First class)

- *Background knowledge* – the project demonstrates: comprehensive depth of knowledge and scientific awareness; clear understanding of major theories, principles and concepts; very competent in competence in identifying new approach in problem formulation, modelling, framework, and methodology.

- *Experiment and implementation competence* – the project shows evidence of complete experiment and/or implementation of objective; mostly appropriate use of methods and tools; clear evaluation of the outcomes and relevant judgements.
- *Originality and contributions* – projects in this classification to a curtained extent show originality and innovation in problem formulation, solution (algorithms/system design) approach, implementation (code), testing and validation (experimental analysis).
- *Presentation quality* – the project demonstrates: clear and lucid report writing, uniform reference and bibliography; high quality of tables and figures and their reference in text; excellent and well-directed presentation; logically structured report; largely correct grammar and spelling.

70% – 79% (First class)

Excellent knowledge and depth understanding of principles and concepts; clear evidence of relevant application of theory and/or empirical results where applicable; demonstrate the steps taken, few minor errors in calculations, using recognised methods; appropriate evidence of using analytical and interpretative skills in solving the problem, evaluating outcomes and making judgements; excellent referencing and bibliography; excellent, well-directed presentation and structured report; using correct grammar and spelling.

60% – 69% (Upper second class)

Comprehensive knowledge and depth of understanding of principles and concepts; evidence of relevant application of theory and/or empirical results, where applicable; minor errors in the steps taken or in calculations, recognised methods not always used correctly; some evidence of using analytical and interpretative skills in solving the problem, evaluating outcomes and making judgements; comprehensive referencing and bibliography; good quality presentation, well-structured report; using correct grammar and spelling.

50% – 59% (Lower second class)

Appropriate knowledge and understanding of principles and concepts; some relevant application of theory and/or empirical results where applicable; steps taken in calculations lack clarity, recognised methods not used or used incorrectly; limited evidence of using analytical and interpretative skills in solving the problem, evaluating outcomes and making judgements; adequate referencing and bibliography; acceptable presentation and structured report; acceptable grammar and spelling.

40% – 49% (Third class)

Basic knowledge of key principles and concepts; limited evidence of relevant application of theory and/or empirical results; steps are taken in calculations lack clarity, calculations have numerous major errors, recognised methods not used or used incorrectly; limited use of analytical and interpretative skills; limited referencing and bibliography; weak presentation and structured report, grammar and spelling

0% – 39% (Fail)

Insufficient evidence of key principles and concepts; no evidence of application of theory and/or empirical results; no steps are taken in calculations, recognised methods not used; no analysis or interpretation; little or no referencing and bibliography; unacceptable presentation, structured report; poor grammar and spelling.